

MELANIE PATTERSON

DESIGN + FRONT-END DEVELOPMENT

+1 786 261 9656 · hello@melanie.studio · melanie.studio

I design and build for the web, blending front-end development with visual design to create systems that are both functional and human.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Languages: React · JavaScript · HTML/CSS · SQL · Liquid · PHP · jQuery

Tools: Figma · Supabase · Git/GitHub · Slate (CRM) · Shopify · Squarespace · Visual Studio Code · AI-Assisted Development (Claude Code) · Illustrator · InDesign · Photoshop · Premiere Pro · After Effects

SELECTED WORK EXPERIENCE

Assistant Director of Admissions, Communication & Outreach · Rhode Island School of Design (RISD) / Providence, RI / Aug 2021 - Present

- Write conditional Liquid logic for personalized decision letters and emails, including program-switch language across 30 program variants
- Write SQL to personalize merge field data across email and portal systems
- Design and build automated CRM portals and email/task workflows (HTML/CSS, SQL) that reduce manual work across the Admissions team
- Hand-code HTML email templates; leading shift to a component-based drag-and-drop email system

Admissions Officer · RISD / Providence, RI / Jul 2016 - Jul 2021

- Ran 5 admissions cycles: application evaluation, portfolio reviews, and recruitment travel
- Designed and presented recruitment content (slideshows, social media)

Brand, Product & Web Designer (Contract) · BB Trading Worldwide / Remote / Feb 2016 - June 2024

- Owned brand identity packaging redesign across a multi-line fragrance and skincare system, supporting a full brand repositioning
- Designed and built the brand's Shopify ecommerce site, still in use since launch

Creative Marketing Director · Yours Truly Brand / Miami, FL / Sep 2015 - Jan 2016

- Built social/SEO/paid marketing strategy and influencer campaigns that contributed to inventory sellouts

PROJECTS

Glow Up · Skincare Routine & Tracking App (In Progress) / React · Supabase

- Designing and building a full-stack skincare tracking app with a custom design system (theme tokens, typography, color) and component architecture
- Conducting code review, bug-triage process and beta testing

melanie.studio · Personal Portfolio Site / React · Vite

- Built a custom visual system and reusable component architecture (gallery, lightbox, browser-frame, etc.)

EDUCATION

RISD Continuing Education · Interactive & Graphic Design Coursework / Providence, RI / 2018 - 2024

Rhode Island School of Design · BFA, Illustration / Providence, RI / 2014

Central Saint Martins (University of the Arts London) · Graphic Design Semester Programme · London, UK / 2013

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Dear BAGGU Hiring Team,

I like to make pretty things for the internet. That's how I sum up my methodology for making. My origin story is perhaps a bit unconventional, having written my first lines of code at nine years old. I went on to develop my own website from the ground up—a fashion blog—an early relic of hyper-modern influencer culture that went on to become sponsored by major fashion and beauty brands, and featured in Glamour, Teen Vogue, and Marie Claire magazines. Meanwhile, I pursued studies in Illustration and Graphic Design at Rhode Island School of Design (RISD) and Central Saint Martins. Today, my career lives at the intersection of visual design systems, ecommerce production, and front-end engineering. Whether authoring custom React components, refreshing a visually dated CRM system, or customizing ecommerce platforms, I specialize in acting as the bridge between creative vision and technical execution. As someone who has long-respected BAGGU's position on sustainable, accessible and playful design, I am thrilled to apply for the Associate Web Developer role.

What really stands out to me in joining BAGGU's engineering team is the opportunity to partner directly with your Creative Studio and E-Commerce teams. I bring a strong art foundation, UI/UX experience, and a creative instinct that treats accessibility and the unexpected as compatible, not competing.

In my role as Assistant Director of Admissions, Communication & Outreach at RISD, I regularly bring complex design solutions into my work beyond what project scope requires because of responsibility to RISD's positioning and praxis. Some examples:

- **Frontend & Interactive Engineering:** When RISD's MarComm design team refreshed our admitted student story, I replaced a flat, native CRM script with a custom, multi-layered confetti animation that plays dynamically on load when students receive their admitted decisions. To keep high-frequency communications visually engaging, I've been building interactive JavaScript Canvas animations to use as backdrops for emails.
- **Design System Governance & Architecture:** During a multi-year campus rebrand, I authored custom style overrides to maintain visual consistency in the subdomain that houses our CRM, later coordinating directly with MarComm's Digital Experience Director and web developer to engineer a native, brand-matched overhaul.

Across a decade of in-house and freelance work, I've garnered extensive platform adaptability including working in ecommerce in the fashion and beauty space, from custom WordPress builds, to a Shopify storefront that reached \$20k/month in direct-to-consumer sales, alongside ecommerce content and platform work across two additional fashion-industry roles. I take pride in taking whatever framework I'm given, whether legacy or modern, and making decisions that improve the experience for my teammates as much as our end-users.

I am looking to bring this hybrid background—combining lifelong dev curiosity, e-commerce psychology from the standpoint of both an influencer and consumer, and a design-first operational mindset—into a structured, creative in-house team. I would love the opportunity to support and learn from your senior developers, streamline workflows for ecommerce, and help bring BAGGU's web experiences to life.

Thank you for your time and consideration. You can explore my web projects and portfolio at melanie.studio and check out my code on GitHub at github.com/melaniepatterson.

Warmly,

Melanie Patterson